



Tentacles

Shell  
fragments

## SPREADING FANS

Many marine worms that live in the sand must wait for the sea to flood the beach at high tide. Then they emerge from their burrows and spread fans of tentacles, which they use to collect food from the water. They include several types of tube worms that mix slime from their bodies with seashore material to make tubes. This helps to protect their soft bodies. The tubes rise above the sand surface, enabling the worms to gather food from clear water.

### ◀ SAND MASON WORM

*This worm uses shell fragments and sand to build its tube. Even the tentacles of the sand mason have tubes. The worm itself can be up to 12 in (30 cm) long.*



### ▲ RAZOR CLAMS

*Long-shelled razor clams sometimes emerge from the sand, but vanish if they sense danger.*

## SECRET SHELLFISH

Burrowing clams and other mollusks emerge to feed at high tide. They usually keep their bodies hidden, but extend fleshy, flexible siphon tubes to gather food. Most clams draw food-bearing seawater through a filter, while others such as tellins collect food from the flooded beach surface. When the tide level falls again, the clams retreat back into the sand, so they become invisible to seabirds and other enemies.



### ▲ LESSER WEEVER

*Half-buried by sand in the shallows, this weever is protected by venomous spines.*

## HIGH-TIDE HUNTERS

The burrowing animals that feed when the beach is flooded at high tide are in turn preyed upon by fish that swim in from the sea. Many of these hunters are seafloor-feeding specialists such as the venomous weevers, flatfish, and rays, but they also include bigger fish such as sea bass and cod.

